Minister's Office].

Very soon Kiran started to get 'signals' that she would be tolerated only for the duration of the games and not a day longer.

Many 'carrots' were dangled in front of her even during the months preceding the games. For instance, she was offered scholarships for courses in traffic regulation training in Australia and later in Japan. Naturally, she had no inclination to be away from Delhi for months while the onerous responsibility of regulating traffic during the games was upon her. Even while she was conducting meetings, where plans were being discussed, she would be called up on the telephone by senior ministry officials congratulating her and wishing her bon voyage. She could only refuse these scholarships as politely as she could.

'Was it because they wanted you out so that they could claim credit for the arrangements?'

Kiran responds: 'I wonder what would have been done to me if the traffic situation had been chaotic during the Asian games. Could I then say sorry, I couldn't plan enough because I have just come back from Japan or Australia? To me these foreign trips at that point of time were out of place. I had only *one goal* and that was to achieve an orderly and organized traffic flow, to leave no one with a complaint that he or she could not make it because of traffic problems. We all wanted excellence in our arrangements.'

Is Kiran being a bit spiteful, one wonders, but only for a moment. Forthcoming events underscore her belief.

The era of colour television came to India along with the Asian games. As is the practice before major events like the Republic Day parade and the Independence Day functions, the DCP (Traffic) is required to come on TV prior to the event and explain the traffic routes and the restrictions imposed in some areas to the public. Kiran naturally had this responsibility. She said she would come immediately but was hastily informed that she could send a junior officer.

'There are nineteen stadia spread over nineteen zones,' Kiran explained to the authorities concerned. 'My juniors are each in charge of a zone and if you want I'll send them to you to explain the traffic regulations of their respective zones.'

This explanation obviously had them stumped.

Kiran continued: 'Unfortunately, I am the only DCP (Traffic), there isn't even an Additional DCP. So how do you want it?'

She was told that there would be no prior recordings and she would have to go live on air. If she made a mistake, the higher-ups pointed out, she had it.

She did go on the air, ten times at that, and without a single flaw. The one officer whom some of her seniors were never tired of saying was publicity hungry got national and international coverage, in colour, ten times over, on the national network and some foreign channels!

She was thus publicly rewarded many times over, by her own meticulous preparation, tireless hard work, total family support and her fearless and non-sparing sense of justice.